Tuğba Somuncu

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Position

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Teaching Assistant Professor, Department of Economics 2024–present

Education

Iowa State University
Ph.D., Economics 2018–2024
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
M.S., Economic Analysis 2016–2018
Istanbul Technical University
M.S., Economics 2014–2016
Marmara University
B.Sc., Chemical Engineering 2008–2013
Erasmus Exchange Program, University of Bologna, Italy, Spring 2012

Fields

Research: Environmental Economics, Public Economics, Health Economics
Teaching: Environmental Economics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Principles of Economics

Working Papers

Learning Downwind: Industrial Chemical Accidents and Student Achievement

Fighting Fire with Fire(fighting Foam): The Long Run Effects of PFAS Use at U.S. Military Installations (with I. Jacqz and J. Voorheis) • *Under review* • U.S. Census WP • Press

Disparities in PFAS Exposure (with I. Jacqz)

Environmental Regulations, Imperfect Mobility, and the Gender Adaptation Gap

Work in Progress

Extreme Weather, Hospital Closures, and Emergency Department Utilization in the United States (with A. Earle)

Teaching

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
ECON 455: Environmental Economic Theory (9 sections) F2024–present
ECON 410H: Intermediate Microeconomics (Honors) (3 sections) S2025–present
ECON 410: Intermediate Microeconomics (1 section) S2025
ECON 101: Introduction to Economics (2 sections) F2024–S2025

Iowa State University
ECON 321: Economics of Discrimination (1 section, instructor) S2022

Awards and Grants

Russell Sage Foundation (for Fighting Fire with Fire(fighting Foam))	2023
Teaching Excellence Award, Graduate College, Iowa State University	2022
Graduate Fellowship, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2016–2018
Best Scientific Presentation Award, ENERDAY	2016
Erasmus Exchange Grant	2012

Presentations

AERE at the Midwest Economics Association (scheduled)	2027
Southern Economic Association; AERE Summer Conference	2023
Camp Resources XXVIII; Midwest Economics Association	2022
CSWEP Mentoring Workshop	2021
Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics	2020
BC3 Basque Centre for Climate Change Summer School	2018
ENERDAY Conference on Energy Economics and Technology	2016

Student Advising

Anthony R. Swenson — Honors Thesis, Highest Honors
Annabel E. Lissade — Honors Thesis
Brigit Pierce — Honors Thesis; Summer Research
Steven Yu — Summer Research, Wesslen Research Award
Madison Kim — Honors Contract

Service

Faculty Advisor for Graduate Students, Women in Economics, UNC Chapel Hill	2026
Member, Chair's Advisory Committee, UNC Chapel Hill	2025
Small Group Leader, ISU Cardinal Women Student Program	2022, 2023
Press Secretary, ISU Economics Graduate Student Association	2019

Referee

The Journal of Economic Inequality